

5 things we found when we studied how companies respond to supply chain disruptions.

We analysed 1,000+ documented cases.
Here is what the evidence shows.

93%

**of companies use the
same three levers
every single time.**

Build inventory. Dual-source. Regionalise.

Regardless of disruption type. Regardless of sector.

Since at least 2020.

**Fewer than 7% of companies
introduce a genuinely new
countermeasure during a disruption.**

The rest don't know what they're missing.

5 days.

The average time to begin a disruption response.

83% of supply chains cannot respond within 24 hours of a disruption.

Average recovery once a disruption takes hold:

3–5 months.

Every day of delay is not linear.

Disruptions compound through tiers.

The blast radius grows with each hour.

30–50%

of annual EBITDA.

The cost of a disruption lasting more than 30 days.

Compare that with a disruption contained within a month:

3–5% of EBITDA.

A 10× difference.

Almost entirely determined by the quality and speed of the response.

The respond phase is the least automated phase in SCRM.

DETECT

Automated

NOTIFY

Automated

RESPOND

Manual

RECOVER

Mostly manual

Academic review of 171 papers found:

Mitigation and handling are
"significantly harder to digitise"
than detection and assessment.

What fills the gap today? A war room.

Spreadsheets. Conference calls.
Exhausted experts. Two weeks to a plan.

GenAI alone cannot solve this.

01 Probabilistic, not deterministic.

Generates plausible outputs. Not provably optimal ones.

02 Cannot enforce hard constraints.

A capacity of 500 units is a suggestion, not a ceiling.

03 No objective function.

Answers 'what could we do?' Not 'what is optimal?'

The answer: GenAI for language and explanation. Mathematical optimisation for feasibility and correctness.

Both together. Neither alone.

A category gap that is finally closing.

\$43–47M estimated annual disruption cost per enterprise (Interos)

No MQ no Gartner Magic Quadrant exists for prescriptive disruption response optimisation — the category is still open

2030 by which Gartner projects 50% of SCM solutions will employ agentic AI for autonomous execution

The respond-and-recover phase is the last unoptimised phase of supply chain risk management.

The full research is available below.

Full research available. Free to download.

The Missing Phase:

Why Supply Chain Disruption Response
Remains Unoptimised

- 5 evidence-backed findings
- Competitive landscape analysis
- Why planning tools fail during live disruptions
- The GenAI limitation — explained structurally
- Strategic implications for procurement & ops leaders

Link in the first comment below.

`ecocomitychain.ai`
